

hair. A balanced diet won't solve every hair problem, but it can head quite a few off at the pass. For instance, if you have an iron deficiency, your hair may thin out.



3. Go natural

Hair dye is expensive, and it can make keeping your hair healthy much harder. Consider going back to your natural hair color for a while and save some serious dough. The same goes for perms. I've also been known to dye my hair myself. It isn't hard, but I recommend having a second pair of hands around.

4. Shop around for products

The same tips for shopping frugally for groceries work on hair-care products. I buy on sale, clip coupons, and pick up bulk bottles. I do have a preferred brand that I tend to stock up on, but it's not the most expensive brand on the shelf. According to a few hair-

styling friends, the *expensive hair products aren't really any better* than cheaper options. Wholesale distributors will also often provide great deals, as do online vendors.

5. Barter

If you really do prefer the job a professional will do on your hair, you don't have to give up those regular visits. But it's worth finding a stylist willing to accept a payment other than cash. During high school, I traded babysitting for haircuts on a regular basis. I didn't have to pay for a haircut and I could generally do my homework at the same time.

6. Go organic

Sure, organic brands can be more expensive than their chemically enhanced counterparts, but many organic shampoos and conditioners do not contain sulfates. While sulfates do remove oil and other junk from your hair, they also strip it and create frizz and other problems. If you can switch to sulfate-free products, you can stop using other products—like anti-frizz mousse. There's a period of adjustment and your hair might be slightly oily in comparison, but after a few weeks, your hair should be healthier. — **Thursday Bram**